

How to build a chatbot integration with the Virtual Agent



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servicenow®

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ServiceNow conversational AI experience anywhere

Enable customers to leverage ServiceNow solutions in a conversational experience from any chat interface that they have invested in and/or their users are familiar with.



Virtual Agent API – enabling bot-to-bot integration

What is it?

A framework of REST APIs with standard request/response payload

Who is the Target Audience?

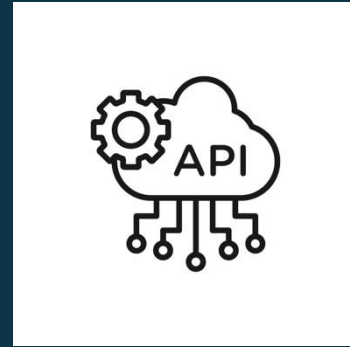
Customers who have invested in a bot ecosystem already and wish to integrate with the ServiceNow Virtual Agent.

What is the benefit?

1. Enhance the capability of your existing bot ecosystem by bringing in the Virtual Agent with its data, intelligence, and workflows
2. Easily plug into an existing bot ecosystem through a backend API driven integration
3. Provide a seamless and robust experience to end users without disrupting the chat experience they are already familiar with

When to use Virtual Agent API, MCP, and A2A

Virtual Agent API



What is it?: REST API framework developed by ServiceNow for chatbot integration

Use for: Connecting ServiceNow Virtual Agent with another bot interface

MCP (Model Context Protocol)



What is it?: Open standard by Anthropic for connecting AI applications (agents) to external systems.

Use for: Connecting Now Assist AI Agents to external or Now Assist tools

A2A (Agent2Agent)

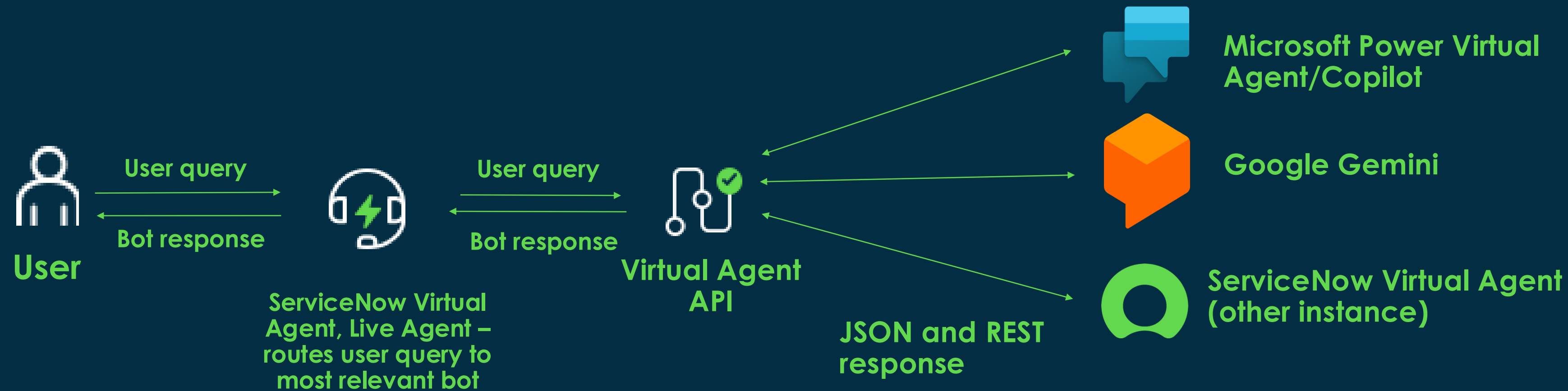


What is it?: Open standard by Google that enables AI agents from different systems to communicate and collaborate.

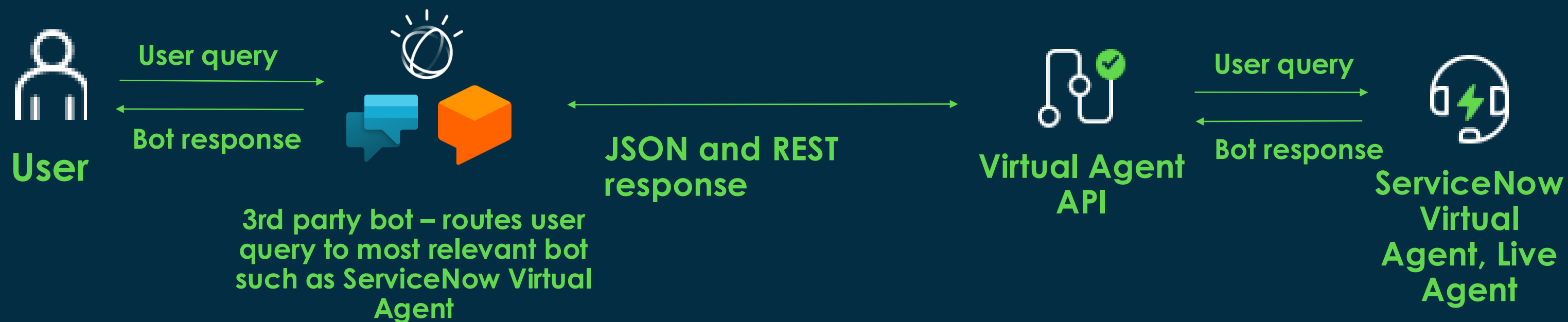
Use for: Connecting Now Assist AI Agents with external AI Agents

Virtual Agent API architecture

Virtual Agent as Primary Bot (Bot Interconnect)



Virtual Agent as Secondary Bot



Use the Virtual Agent API request/response to integrate any bot with the ServiceNow Virtual Agent as a secondary bot.

Things to keep in mind

- Requires a Pro/Enterprise SKU with Virtual Agent. Download the Virtual Agent API store app (v4.1+).
- Async mode is default and recommended approach.
- Routing to Agent Chat is supported

New Improvements (v4.1+)

- Outbound configuration improved to support REST or scripted invocation
- New OOB REST connection provides OOB connection alias, retry policy, multiple auth types (originally only support Basic, OAuth)

More resources

- Visit our Virtual Agent & NLU Community forum - "Getting started with the Virtual Agent API"
- Implementation KB for Microsoft Azure bot-to-bot: **KB1436882**
- Documentation: <https://servicenow.com/docs>
- Ask the Experts sessions on A2A (Agent2Agent) protocol: CCE6106
 - Tuesday 2pm
 - Wednesday 4pm